Conjure in African American Society

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Overview & Sanctuary Summary:
Comprehensive historical study exploring the social and spiritual role of conjure from slavery to the present day.

Jeffrey Anderson documents how conjure functioned as an essential system of healthcare, justice, psychological resilience, and spiritual defense for enslaved Africans in North America.

Historical Pillars:

• Root Doctors as Community Protectors: In an era where legal justice and humane medicine were denied to Black people, root doctors provided remedies, protective charms, and psychological empowerment.

• The Mojo Bag (Toby / Conjure Hand): Portable, hidden shrines worn beneath garments to ensure physical safety and road opening.

• Resistance and Autonomy: Conjure was an act of rebellion—affirming that human dignity cannot be enslaved when spirit remains free.

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